remember China's then foreign minister reminding Southeast Asian nations at a regional meeting in 2010 that "China is a big country and you are small countries."[21] Adding to the region's unease was Beijing's flat rejection in July 2016 of The Hague's Permanent Court of Arbitration's ruling against China's South China Sea claims, stripping away the fiction that international law would moderate Beijing's behavior when strategic interests were at stake. Unlike Japan, moreover, China has not sought to win friends by providing defensive equipment; the bulk of China's military sales in Asia goes to North Korea, Bangladesh, and Burma, forging, along with Pakistan (the largest recipient of Chinese arms transfers), a loose grouping that is isolated from those nations cooperating with both Japan and the United States.

Yet for all its bluster and intimidation, China's approach, a combination of realpolitik and limited *machtpolitik*, is more likely to secure its goals, at least in the short run, if not longer. Smaller nations are under no illusion that they can successfully resist China's encroachments; they hope for either a natural moderation of Beijing's behavior or an overreach that will allow communal pressure to influence Chinese decision making. In this calculation, Japan appears primarily as a spoiler. While Tokyo is able to protect its own territories in the East China Sea, it knows that its power in the region is limited. This mandates not only a continuing, if enhanced, alliance relationship with the United States but also an approach that helps complicate Beijing's decision making, such as by providing defensive equipment to Southeast Asian nations. Tokyo understands that it can potentially help disrupt, but not deter, Chinese expansion in Asia. Put differently, Asia is faced with competing security strategies from its two most powerful nations: Japan seeks to be loved; China, feared.

VII.

A deeper manifestation of Sino-Japanese rivalry is the model for national development that each implicitly offers for Asia. It is not the